

MoodHaven: Contextual Mood & Awareness Journal

Problem Statement

- What real-world problem does the app address?
Many individuals struggle with "emotional illiteracy", the inability to accurately label what they feel (e.g., confusing "anxiety" with "stress"). Traditional journaling apps often force users to find a "solution" immediately or judge their negative feelings, rather than providing a safe space to simply "be" with their emotions and understand their triggers.
- Why is this problem worth solving?
By shifting the focus from "fixing" emotions to "acknowledging" them, users build emotional resilience. Providing tools for "delayed understanding" (for when they don't know how they feel) helps prevent repression and burnout.

Proposed Solution

Emote is a digital journal that prioritizes emotional honesty and safety. It uses a color-coded emoji system to help users categorize complex feelings (Joy, Grief, Burnout) and provides "Gentle Reflections", non-judgmental prompts that encourage self-compassion. It features a "Comfort Mode" for distress and allows users to build their own library of coping mechanisms.

Core Features (Minimum of 5)

1. Granular Mood Logging (The Core Input):
 - Primary Moods (Color-Coded): Users select from 5 core categories with specific colors: Happy (Yellow), Sad (Blue), Angry (Red), Neutral (Gray), and Anxious (Purple).
 - Sub-Moods & Intensity: After selecting a core mood, users pick specific nuances (e.g., *Sad* → *Loneliness*, *Grief*) and rate the intensity from 1 (Low) to 5 (High).
 - Optional States: Includes distinct toggles for "Stress/Burnout," "Excited," or "Drained".
 - "I Don't Know" Option: A dedicated button for "Delayed Understanding," allowing users to log an entry without forcing a label, which they can revisit later (Emotional Landmark).
2. Smart Journaling & Gentle Reflections (Interactivity):
 - Trigger Tagging: Users tag what caused the mood (e.g., Work, Family, Social Media).
 - Adaptive Prompts: Based on the selected trigger and mood, the app asks a gentle, non-judgmental question.

- *Example:* If "Anxious" is selected, the app asks: *"What would you tell a friend who felt this way?"* or *"How did you recover yourself last time?"*.

3. Personal Coping Library (CRUD):

- User-Built Lists: Users create their own "Safety Menu" of things that help them (e.g., "Pet the dog," "Drink water," "Call Mom"). This empowers the user rather than giving generic advice.
- Body & Behavior (Optional): Users can link physical responses to their entry (e.g., "Tight Chest," "Clenched Jaw") to build awareness of how emotions manifest physically.

4. Analytics & "Emotional Replay" (Data Handling):

- Mood Patterns: A dashboard showing daily, weekly, and monthly summaries. It highlights correlations (e.g., "You often feel Drained on Mondays").
- Emotional Replay: A visual summary that plays back the week's emotions as a color gradient, helping users see the "flow" of their week rather than just static numbers.

5. Comfort Mode (Safety Feature):

- Emergency Toggle: A button that instantly simplifies the UI, removing complex analytics and replacing them with words of assurance and calming colors.
- Reassurance Logic: The app uses strictly non-judgmental language (e.g., instead of "You should fix this," it says "It makes sense that you feel this way").